Wassim Guerfali

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EDUCATION

Alma College, Alma, MI · B.S. Economics and B.S. Mathematics — Expected April 2027
Economics GPA: 3.93/4.00 | Cumulative GPA: 3.50/4.00

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Senior Thesis in Economics (sole author), *advised by Dr. Matthew Hinkel* — 2026–Present
Condition-Blind by Design: Does Michigan's Act 51 Road Funding Reach the Roads That Need It Most?

- Wrote a Python parser that extracts 29,376 county payment records from 43 state PDF reports.
- Matched 7,042 pavement segments across three years of road condition surveys in 29 counties.
- Found that funding per road-mile is unrelated to road condition; formula inputs explain 93% of it.

Santa Clara Construction Cost Study *(co-author with Dr. Hinkel and L. Petrucci, NCIC)* — Aug 2026–Present

- Lead the extraction of certified payroll records from public contractor filings.
- Build worker-level counts and contractor union-density measures for the cost analysis.

Undergraduate Research Assistant *to Dr. Vinitha Rachel Varghese* — Summer 2026

- Collected county-level Social Security (OASDI and SSI) beneficiary data for 1998–2024.
- Typed in data for years published only as PDFs and merged all years into one panel.

PAPERS

- "State-Directed Investment and Path Dependency: The Determinants of Chinese FDI in Africa in the BRI Era." ECN 317 Econometrics paper, Fall 2025.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Junior Trade Commissioner Intern, *Consulate General of Canada, Detroit* — 2025

- Rotated across several departments and analyzed sector opportunities for trade staff.

Mentoring Intern, *Shiv Nadar School, Delhi, India* — 2024

- Mentored 170 students and organized Model UN conferences for the school.

LEADERSHIP AND CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

Resident Advisor, *Alma College Residence Life*. First point of contact for 30 residents in my hall. — 2026–Present

International Students' Assistant, *Alma College Student Success*. Help international students with academic and campus questions. — 2024–Present

Admissions Tour Guide, *Alma College*. Lead campus tours for prospective students and families. — Present

Vice President, *Delta Gamma Tau*. Lead the philanthropy committee and organize the annual GAM Games fundraiser. — 2025–Present

Head of Position Paper Editing Committee, *Alma College Model UN*. Edit delegates' position papers and coach their writing before conferences. — 2026

HONORS

Model UN: Outstanding Delegate Award; Outstanding Delegation Award (3 consecutive years); NMUN Position Paper Award | Alma P-Global Fellowships (India; Canada) | Business Professionals of America national awards

SKILLS

Software	Stata, R, Python, Git/GitHub
Languages	Arabic, French, English

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Economics	Principles of Microeconomics; Principles of Macroeconomics; Quantitative Methods; Econometrics; International Trade; International Finance; Environmental Policy Analysis; Economics of Education; Economics Practicum (×2)
Mathematics & Computing	Calculus I–II; Differential Equations; Discrete Mathematics; Mathematical Structures; Elementary Statistics; Applied Statistical Methods; Multivariable Calculus and Linear Algebra *(in progress)*; Abstract Algebra and Numerical Analysis *(Winter 2027)*; Problem-Solving With Python; Algorithms and Justice